

STARTING STRONG

Essential Truths for
New Christians

A 12-Week Workbook

[ILLUSTRATION: seedling growing
into strong tree with deep roots]

12 Foundations for Lifelong Faith

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STARTING STRONG

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WEEK 1: SALVATION

What happened when I said yes to Jesus?

KEY VERSE: Ephesians 2:8-9

THE BASICS:

When you accepted Jesus as your Lord and Savior, several things happened:

1. Your sins were completely forgiven (past, present, future)
2. You received eternal life - a relationship with God that never ends
3. The Holy Spirit came to live inside you
4. You became part of God's family
5. Your name was written in the Book of Life

IMPORTANT TO KNOW:

- Salvation is a GIFT, not something you earn (Ephesians 2:8-9)
- You can't lose your salvation by messing up (Romans 8:38-39)
- Salvation changes your eternity AND your today
- It's the beginning of a journey, not the end

Week 1: SALVATION - SCRIPTURE STUDY

Read: Ephesians 2:8-9 (look it up in your Bible)

Write the verse in your own words:

What does this verse tell me about GOD?

What does this verse tell me about ME?

What should I DO because of this verse?

Questions I still have:

Week 1: SALVATION - EXERCISES

FILL IN THE BLANKS:

Salvation is a _____ from God, not something I _____.

The topic of salvation matters because _____.

One thing I learned this week: _____.

God wants me to _____.

TRUE OR FALSE:

☐ T ☐ F God's love depends on my behavior.

☐ T ☐ F I need to understand everything before I can grow.

☐ T ☐ F The Bible is relevant to my life today.

☐ T ☐ F I can talk to God about anything.

THIS WEEK'S CHALLENGE:

Write out your salvation story in 3-5 sentences.

Week 1: SALVATION - MY JOURNAL

What I'm feeling about my faith this week:

Something new I learned about God:

My prayer this week:

One thing I want to do differently:

Week 1: SALVATION - GROUP DISCUSSION

1. Before becoming a Christian, what did you think about salvation?

2. What surprised you most in this week's lesson?

3. What questions do you still have about salvation?

4. How can this group help you grow in this area?

5. What's one thing you'll do differently this week?

GROUP PRAYER REQUESTS:

WEEK 2: THE BIBLE

How do I read and understand God's Word?

KEY VERSE: 2 Timothy 3:16

THE BASICS:

The Bible is God's written Word to humanity. It contains:

- 66 books written over 1,500 years by 40+ authors
- Old Testament (before Jesus) - 39 books
- New Testament (Jesus and after) - 27 books

WHY READ IT:

- It reveals who God is
- It shows you how to live
- It gives wisdom for decisions
- It strengthens your faith
- It's how God speaks to you

START HERE: Gospel of John, Psalms, Proverbs

Week 2: THE BIBLE - SCRIPTURE STUDY

Read: 2 Timothy 3:16 (look it up in your Bible)

Write the verse in your own words:

What does this verse tell me about GOD?

What does this verse tell me about ME?

What should I DO because of this verse?

Questions I still have:

Week 2: THE BIBLE - EXERCISES

FILL IN THE BLANKS:

Salvation is a _____ from God, not something I _____.

The topic of the bible matters because _____.

One thing I learned this week: _____.

God wants me to _____.

TRUE OR FALSE:

☐ T ☐ F God's love depends on my behavior.

☐ T ☐ F I need to understand everything before I can grow.

☐ T ☐ F The Bible is relevant to my life today.

☐ T ☐ F I can talk to God about anything.

THIS WEEK'S CHALLENGE:

Read one chapter of the Gospel of John each day.

Week 2: THE BIBLE - MY JOURNAL

What I'm feeling about my faith this week:

Something new I learned about God:

My prayer this week:

One thing I want to do differently:

Week 2: THE BIBLE - GROUP DISCUSSION

1. Before becoming a Christian, what did you think about the bible?

2. What surprised you most in this week's lesson?

3. What questions do you still have about the bible?

4. How can this group help you grow in this area?

5. What's one thing you'll do differently this week?

GROUP PRAYER REQUESTS:

WEEK 3: PRAYER

How do I talk to God?

KEY VERSE: Philippians 4:6

THE BASICS:

Prayer = talking to God. It's a conversation, not a performance.

TYPES OF PRAYER:

- Praise: telling God how great He is
- Thanks: gratitude for what He's done
- Confession: admitting wrongs honestly
- Requests: asking for needs (yours and others')
- Listening: being quiet to hear His voice

TIPS:

- Pray at set times AND throughout the day
- Use your own words (no special language needed)
- Be honest about feelings, doubts, anger - God can handle it
- Keep a prayer journal to track answers

Week 3: PRAYER - SCRIPTURE STUDY

Read: Philippians 4:6 (look it up in your Bible)

Write the verse in your own words:

What does this verse tell me about GOD?

What does this verse tell me about ME?

What should I DO because of this verse?

Questions I still have:

Week 3: PRAYER - EXERCISES

FILL IN THE BLANKS:

Salvation is a _____ from God, not something I _____.

The topic of prayer matters because _____.

One thing I learned this week: _____.

God wants me to _____.

TRUE OR FALSE:

☐ T ☐ F God's love depends on my behavior.

☐ T ☐ F I need to understand everything before I can grow.

☐ T ☐ F The Bible is relevant to my life today.

☐ T ☐ F I can talk to God about anything.

THIS WEEK'S CHALLENGE:

Pray for 5 minutes each morning this week.

Week 3: PRAYER - MY JOURNAL

What I'm feeling about my faith this week:

Something new I learned about God:

My prayer this week:

One thing I want to do differently:

Week 3: PRAYER - GROUP DISCUSSION

1. Before becoming a Christian, what did you think about prayer?

2. What surprised you most in this week's lesson?

3. What questions do you still have about prayer?

4. How can this group help you grow in this area?

5. What's one thing you'll do differently this week?

GROUP PRAYER REQUESTS:

WEEK 4: CHURCH

Why do I need other believers?

KEY VERSE: Hebrews 10:25

THE BASICS:

This week we explore: Why do I need other believers?

Key Scripture: Hebrews 10:25

As a new believer, understanding this topic will help you:

- Grow stronger in your faith
- Live more confidently as a Christian
- Connect more deeply with God and others

Read the key verse several times this week.

Let it sink into your heart and mind.

Week 4: CHURCH - SCRIPTURE STUDY

Read: Hebrews 10:25 (look it up in your Bible)

Write the verse in your own words:

What does this verse tell me about GOD?

What does this verse tell me about ME?

What should I DO because of this verse?

Questions I still have:

Week 4: CHURCH - EXERCISES

FILL IN THE BLANKS:

Salvation is a _____ from God, not something I _____.

The topic of church matters because _____.

One thing I learned this week: _____.

God wants me to _____.

TRUE OR FALSE:

☐ T ☐ F God's love depends on my behavior.

☐ T ☐ F I need to understand everything before I can grow.

☐ T ☐ F The Bible is relevant to my life today.

☐ T ☐ F I can talk to God about anything.

THIS WEEK'S CHALLENGE:

Visit one church or small group this week.

Week 4: CHURCH - MY JOURNAL

What I'm feeling about my faith this week:

Something new I learned about God:

My prayer this week:

One thing I want to do differently:

Week 4: CHURCH - GROUP DISCUSSION

1. Before becoming a Christian, what did you think about church?

2. What surprised you most in this week's lesson?

3. What questions do you still have about church?

4. How can this group help you grow in this area?

5. What's one thing you'll do differently this week?

GROUP PRAYER REQUESTS:

WEEK 5: BAPTISM

What is baptism and should I do it?

KEY VERSE: Romans 6:4

THE BASICS:

This week we explore: What is baptism and should I do it?

Key Scripture: Romans 6:4

As a new believer, understanding this topic will help you:

- Grow stronger in your faith
- Live more confidently as a Christian
- Connect more deeply with God and others

Read the key verse several times this week.

Let it sink into your heart and mind.

Week 5: BAPTISM - SCRIPTURE STUDY

Read: Romans 6:4 (look it up in your Bible)

Write the verse in your own words:

What does this verse tell me about GOD?

What does this verse tell me about ME?

What should I DO because of this verse?

Questions I still have:

Week 5: BAPTISM - EXERCISES

FILL IN THE BLANKS:

Salvation is a _____ from God, not something I _____.

The topic of baptism matters because _____.

One thing I learned this week: _____.

God wants me to _____.

TRUE OR FALSE:

☐ T ☐ F God's love depends on my behavior.

☐ T ☐ F I need to understand everything before I can grow.

☐ T ☐ F The Bible is relevant to my life today.

☐ T ☐ F I can talk to God about anything.

THIS WEEK'S CHALLENGE:

Watch a video or read an article about baptism.

Week 5: BAPTISM - MY JOURNAL

What I'm feeling about my faith this week:

Something new I learned about God:

My prayer this week:

One thing I want to do differently:

Week 5: BAPTISM - GROUP DISCUSSION

1. Before becoming a Christian, what did you think about baptism?

2. What surprised you most in this week's lesson?

3. What questions do you still have about baptism?

4. How can this group help you grow in this area?

5. What's one thing you'll do differently this week?

GROUP PRAYER REQUESTS:

WEEK 6: COMMUNION

What is the Lord's Supper?

KEY VERSE: 1 Corinthians 11:24-25

THE BASICS:

This week we explore: What is the Lord's Supper?

Key Scripture: 1 Corinthians 11:24-25

As a new believer, understanding this topic will help you:

- Grow stronger in your faith
- Live more confidently as a Christian
- Connect more deeply with God and others

Read the key verse several times this week.

Let it sink into your heart and mind.

Week 6: COMMUNION - SCRIPTURE STUDY

Read: 1 Corinthians 11:24-25 (look it up in your Bible)

Write the verse in your own words:

What does this verse tell me about GOD?

What does this verse tell me about ME?

What should I DO because of this verse?

Questions I still have:

Week 6: COMMUNION - EXERCISES

FILL IN THE BLANKS:

Salvation is a _____ from God, not something I _____.

The topic of communion matters because _____.

One thing I learned this week: _____.

God wants me to _____.

TRUE OR FALSE:

☐ T ☐ F God's love depends on my behavior.

☐ T ☐ F I need to understand everything before I can grow.

☐ T ☐ F The Bible is relevant to my life today.

☐ T ☐ F I can talk to God about anything.

THIS WEEK'S CHALLENGE:

Take communion at church this Sunday.

Week 6: COMMUNION - MY JOURNAL

What I'm feeling about my faith this week:

Something new I learned about God:

My prayer this week:

One thing I want to do differently:

Week 6: COMMUNION - GROUP DISCUSSION

1. Before becoming a Christian, what did you think about communion?

2. What surprised you most in this week's lesson?

3. What questions do you still have about communion?

4. How can this group help you grow in this area?

5. What's one thing you'll do differently this week?

GROUP PRAYER REQUESTS:

WEEK 7: FORGIVENESS

How do I deal with guilt and forgive others?

KEY VERSE: Colossians 3:13

THE BASICS:

This week we explore: How do I deal with guilt and forgive others?

Key Scripture: Colossians 3:13

As a new believer, understanding this topic will help you:

- Grow stronger in your faith
- Live more confidently as a Christian
- Connect more deeply with God and others

Read the key verse several times this week.

Let it sink into your heart and mind.

Week 7: FORGIVENESS - SCRIPTURE STUDY

Read: Colossians 3:13 (look it up in your Bible)

Write the verse in your own words:

What does this verse tell me about GOD?

What does this verse tell me about ME?

What should I DO because of this verse?

Questions I still have:

Week 7: FORGIVENESS - EXERCISES

FILL IN THE BLANKS:

Salvation is a _____ from God, not something I _____.

The topic of forgiveness matters because _____.

One thing I learned this week: _____.

God wants me to _____.

TRUE OR FALSE:

☐ T ☐ F God's love depends on my behavior.

☐ T ☐ F I need to understand everything before I can grow.

☐ T ☐ F The Bible is relevant to my life today.

☐ T ☐ F I can talk to God about anything.

THIS WEEK'S CHALLENGE:

Write a letter of forgiveness (you don't have to send it).

Week 7: FORGIVENESS - MY JOURNAL

What I'm feeling about my faith this week:

Something new I learned about God:

My prayer this week:

One thing I want to do differently:

Week 7: FORGIVENESS - GROUP DISCUSSION

1. Before becoming a Christian, what did you think about forgiveness?

2. What surprised you most in this week's lesson?

3. What questions do you still have about forgiveness?

4. How can this group help you grow in this area?

5. What's one thing you'll do differently this week?

GROUP PRAYER REQUESTS:

WEEK 8: HOLY SPIRIT

Who is the Holy Spirit and what does He do?

KEY VERSE: John 14:26

THE BASICS:

This week we explore: Who is the Holy Spirit and what does He do?

Key Scripture: John 14:26

As a new believer, understanding this topic will help you:

- Grow stronger in your faith
- Live more confidently as a Christian
- Connect more deeply with God and others

Read the key verse several times this week.

Let it sink into your heart and mind.

Week 8: HOLY SPIRIT - SCRIPTURE STUDY

Read: John 14:26 (look it up in your Bible)

Write the verse in your own words:

What does this verse tell me about GOD?

What does this verse tell me about ME?

What should I DO because of this verse?

Questions I still have:

Week 8: HOLY SPIRIT - EXERCISES

FILL IN THE BLANKS:

Salvation is a _____ from God, not something I _____.

The topic of holy spirit matters because _____.

One thing I learned this week: _____.

God wants me to _____.

TRUE OR FALSE:

☐ T ☐ F God's love depends on my behavior.

☐ T ☐ F I need to understand everything before I can grow.

☐ T ☐ F The Bible is relevant to my life today.

☐ T ☐ F I can talk to God about anything.

THIS WEEK'S CHALLENGE:

Ask God to show you the Holy Spirit's work in your day.

Week 8: HOLY SPIRIT - MY JOURNAL

What I'm feeling about my faith this week:

Something new I learned about God:

My prayer this week:

One thing I want to do differently:

Week 8: HOLY SPIRIT - GROUP DISCUSSION

1. Before becoming a Christian, what did you think about holy spirit?

2. What surprised you most in this week's lesson?

3. What questions do you still have about holy spirit?

4. How can this group help you grow in this area?

5. What's one thing you'll do differently this week?

GROUP PRAYER REQUESTS:

WEEK 9: SPIRITUAL GIFTS

What has God gifted me to do?

KEY VERSE: 1 Corinthians 12:7

THE BASICS:

This week we explore: What has God gifted me to do?

Key Scripture: 1 Corinthians 12:7

As a new believer, understanding this topic will help you:

- Grow stronger in your faith
- Live more confidently as a Christian
- Connect more deeply with God and others

Read the key verse several times this week.

Let it sink into your heart and mind.

Week 9: SPIRITUAL GIFTS - SCRIPTURE STUDY

Read: 1 Corinthians 12:7 (look it up in your Bible)

Write the verse in your own words:

What does this verse tell me about GOD?

What does this verse tell me about ME?

What should I DO because of this verse?

Questions I still have:

Week 9: SPIRITUAL GIFTS - EXERCISES

FILL IN THE BLANKS:

Salvation is a _____ from God, not something I _____.

The topic of spiritual gifts matters because _____.

One thing I learned this week: _____.

God wants me to _____.

TRUE OR FALSE:

☐ T ☐ F God's love depends on my behavior.

☐ T ☐ F I need to understand everything before I can grow.

☐ T ☐ F The Bible is relevant to my life today.

☐ T ☐ F I can talk to God about anything.

THIS WEEK'S CHALLENGE:

Take a spiritual gifts assessment online.

Week 9: SPIRITUAL GIFTS - MY JOURNAL

What I'm feeling about my faith this week:

Something new I learned about God:

My prayer this week:

One thing I want to do differently:

Week 9: SPIRITUAL GIFTS - GROUP DISCUSSION

1. Before becoming a Christian, what did you think about spiritual gifts?

2. What surprised you most in this week's lesson?

3. What questions do you still have about spiritual gifts?

4. How can this group help you grow in this area?

5. What's one thing you'll do differently this week?

GROUP PRAYER REQUESTS:

WEEK 10: TEMPTATION

How do I resist sin?

KEY VERSE: 1 Corinthians 10:13

THE BASICS:

This week we explore: How do I resist sin?

Key Scripture: 1 Corinthians 10:13

As a new believer, understanding this topic will help you:

- Grow stronger in your faith
- Live more confidently as a Christian
- Connect more deeply with God and others

Read the key verse several times this week.

Let it sink into your heart and mind.

Week 10: TEMPTATION - SCRIPTURE STUDY

Read: 1 Corinthians 10:13 (look it up in your Bible)

Write the verse in your own words:

What does this verse tell me about GOD?

What does this verse tell me about ME?

What should I DO because of this verse?

Questions I still have:

Week 10: TEMPTATION - EXERCISES

FILL IN THE BLANKS:

Salvation is a _____ from God, not something I _____.

The topic of temptation matters because _____.

One thing I learned this week: _____.

God wants me to _____.

TRUE OR FALSE:

☐ T ☐ F God's love depends on my behavior.

☐ T ☐ F I need to understand everything before I can grow.

☐ T ☐ F The Bible is relevant to my life today.

☐ T ☐ F I can talk to God about anything.

THIS WEEK'S CHALLENGE:

Identify one temptation and write a plan to resist it.

Week 10: TEMPTATION - MY JOURNAL

What I'm feeling about my faith this week:

Something new I learned about God:

My prayer this week:

One thing I want to do differently:

Week 10: TEMPTATION - GROUP DISCUSSION

1. Before becoming a Christian, what did you think about temptation?

2. What surprised you most in this week's lesson?

3. What questions do you still have about temptation?

4. How can this group help you grow in this area?

5. What's one thing you'll do differently this week?

GROUP PRAYER REQUESTS:

WEEK 11: SHARING FAITH

How do I tell others about Jesus?

KEY VERSE: Matthew 28:19-20

THE BASICS:

This week we explore: How do I tell others about Jesus?

Key Scripture: Matthew 28:19-20

As a new believer, understanding this topic will help you:

- Grow stronger in your faith
- Live more confidently as a Christian
- Connect more deeply with God and others

Read the key verse several times this week.

Let it sink into your heart and mind.

Week 11: SHARING FAITH - SCRIPTURE STUDY

Read: Matthew 28:19-20 (look it up in your Bible)

Write the verse in your own words:

What does this verse tell me about GOD?

What does this verse tell me about ME?

What should I DO because of this verse?

Questions I still have:

Week 11: SHARING FAITH - EXERCISES

FILL IN THE BLANKS:

Salvation is a _____ from God, not something I _____.

The topic of sharing faith matters because _____.

One thing I learned this week: _____.

God wants me to _____.

TRUE OR FALSE:

☐ T ☐ F God's love depends on my behavior.

☐ T ☐ F I need to understand everything before I can grow.

☐ T ☐ F The Bible is relevant to my life today.

☐ T ☐ F I can talk to God about anything.

THIS WEEK'S CHALLENGE:

Share your faith story with one person this week.

Week 11: SHARING FAITH - MY JOURNAL

What I'm feeling about my faith this week:

Something new I learned about God:

My prayer this week:

One thing I want to do differently:

Week 11: SHARING FAITH - GROUP DISCUSSION

1. Before becoming a Christian, what did you think about sharing faith?

2. What surprised you most in this week's lesson?

3. What questions do you still have about sharing faith?

4. How can this group help you grow in this area?

5. What's one thing you'll do differently this week?

GROUP PRAYER REQUESTS:

WEEK 12: GROWING DAILY

How do I keep growing for the rest of my life?

KEY VERSE: 2 Peter 3:18

THE BASICS:

This week we explore: How do I keep growing for the rest of my life?

Key Scripture: 2 Peter 3:18

As a new believer, understanding this topic will help you:

- Grow stronger in your faith
- Live more confidently as a Christian
- Connect more deeply with God and others

Read the key verse several times this week.

Let it sink into your heart and mind.

Week 12: GROWING DAILY - SCRIPTURE STUDY

Read: 2 Peter 3:18 (look it up in your Bible)

Write the verse in your own words:

What does this verse tell me about GOD?

What does this verse tell me about ME?

What should I DO because of this verse?

Questions I still have:

Week 12: GROWING DAILY - EXERCISES

FILL IN THE BLANKS:

Salvation is a _____ from God, not something I _____.

The topic of growing daily matters because _____.

One thing I learned this week: _____.

God wants me to _____.

TRUE OR FALSE:

☐ T ☐ F God's love depends on my behavior.

☐ T ☐ F I need to understand everything before I can grow.

☐ T ☐ F The Bible is relevant to my life today.

☐ T ☐ F I can talk to God about anything.

THIS WEEK'S CHALLENGE:

Create a daily routine that includes God.

Week 12: GROWING DAILY - MY JOURNAL

What I'm feeling about my faith this week:

Something new I learned about God:

My prayer this week:

One thing I want to do differently:

Week 12: GROWING DAILY - GROUP DISCUSSION

1. Before becoming a Christian, what did you think about growing daily?

2. What surprised you most in this week's lesson?

3. What questions do you still have about growing daily?

4. How can this group help you grow in this area?

5. What's one thing you'll do differently this week?

GROUP PRAYER REQUESTS:

YOU STARTED STRONG!

12 weeks of foundational faith-building. Well done!

Your journey with God is just beginning.

Remember:

- Progress, not perfection
- God is patient with you
- Every day is a fresh start
- You are never alone
- The best is yet to come

